can be said that the 19th-century Australia was multicultural but only within an Anglo-Celtic context.

Colonists came partly from middle-class professional backgrounds but predominantly from lower-class skilled and semi-skilled occupations. Few aristocrats immigrated to Australia because they had no need to seek out opportunities in such a faraway destination. The social structure of colonial Australia was therefore heavily biased towards the bottom part of a vertical pyramid that denoted social class. Apart from the predominant British and Irish contingent, other smaller groups were also found in the region. German Lutherans helped to settle parts of South Australia in the 1830s and 1840s. Chinese migrants were found in the gold rush settlements. Polynesians, Melanesians, and a few Italians found work in the sugar-producing tropical zone of north Queensland. These migrants retained their ethnic identities while adapting to life in Australia. Before the 1880s, the colonists thought of themselves as Queenslanders, Victorians, South Australians, and so on. As time passed, these groups began to view themselves as Australians with the rise of a homogeneous community.

The growth of white settlement in Australia stemmed from various factors. Children of pioneers and ex-convicts spread beyond the Blue Mountains overland. They made homes in fertile bush areas that were suitable for sheep grazing in the interior of New South Wales and the Port Phillip District. Australia Felix, the name used by Thomas Mitchell for lush pastures in western Victoria, was also a popular destination for settlement. By 1803, settlers from New South Wales migrated to Van Diemen’s Land which became a colony in 1824. New colonies were established in Western Australia including the Swan River colony (1829), South Australia (1836), Victoria (1850), and Queensland (1859). At this time, Victoria still had the post-1843 boundaries of the Port Phillip District. South Australia, Victoria and Queensland were carved out of a ‘greater’ New South Wales. Eventually, Van Diemen’s Land was renamed Tasmania in 1856.

Each colony established a capital city and port: Sydney in New South Wales, Hobart in Van Diemen’s Land, Perth and Fremantle in Western Australia, Adelaide and Port Adelaide in South Australia, Melbourne in